

The 15-Vegetable Small-Backyard Starter List

A free printable guide to the 15 highest-yield, easiest-to-grow vegetables for small backyards — plus the spacing and layout tips that make them actually worth planting.

Why Most Backyard Gardens Fail

New growers tend to plant too much, too spread out, and too many crops that don't actually offset grocery costs. The result is a summer of watering and weeding for a handful of tomatoes. A productive backyard isn't about working harder — it's about a layout and crop plan built around small space, not a leftover version of a farm plan.

What Changes When You Get the System Right

When your space is planned well, a small backyard can produce vegetables, herbs, eggs, and even fruit in the same square footage that used to grow a patch of lawn. Families following a structured system report cutting their produce spending significantly within the first season, while building a level of food security that a grocery store can't offer during shortages or price spikes.

It's a System, Not Just a Garden

Self-sufficiency on a small lot comes from stacking functions: raised beds that maximize yield per square foot, companion planting that reduces pest pressure, rainwater capture that cuts your water bill, and small-scale livestock like chickens or rabbits where space and local rules allow. Each piece supports the others.